

DB201 — Introduction to Databases

Instructor: Dr. Maya Lindqvist

Term: Autumn 2026

Credits: 7.5 ECTS

This course is about storing facts so that many people can ask questions without copying spreadsheets around. We start with entity-relationship modelling, then SQL, then normalisation so your schema does not fight you in week 8.

You will use PostgreSQL in the labs. SQLite is acceptable for experiments on your laptop. Oracle is not required and will not be supported in office hours.

Learning outcomes

After the course you should be able to:

- Draw an ER diagram that a classmate can implement without guessing cardinalities.
- Write SELECT queries with joins, grouping, and nested subqueries.
- Translate a query into relational algebra and back.
- Put a messy table into 3NF and explain which anomaly you just removed.

How the weeks run

Lecture Monday. Lab Wednesday. Bring the lecture PDF to the lab; the exercises assume you have read it, not that you remember a slide from the back of the room.

Office hours: Thursday 10:00–11:30, room 2.04.

Deadlines for Introduction to Databases (DB201)

Dates below are the official ones. If a lab brief paraphrases a date, check this table first.

Item	Weight	Due
Assignment 1: ER modelling	25%	14 October 2026, 23:59
Midterm test	25%	2 November 2026, 09:00
Normalisation mini-project	15%	20 November 2026, 23:59
Final exam	35%	15 December 2026, 09:00

The midterm is 45 minutes, on campus, closed book. The exam is two hours. Both allow a one-page handwritten formula sheet (relational algebra operators only).

Lab 3 is formative: you must submit it to sit the midterm, but it does not carry a percentage.
The lab brief has its own due date.